PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
Board of Education
Tuesday, September 30, 2025

Work Session with Vote on Consent Agenda

Meeting Minutes

(Draft for Approval)

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Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Work Session with a Vote on the Consent Agenda of the Portland Public Schools Board of Education was held at Dr. Matthew Prophet Education Center - Board Auditorium, 501 N. Dixon St, Portland, OR 97227 and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Present:
Chair Eddie Wang; Vice-Chair Michelle DePass; Director Rashelle Chase-Miller, Stephanie Engelsman, Virginia La Forte, Christy Splitt, and Patte Sullivan; Student Representative Ian Ritorto; Superintendent Kimberlee Armstrong

Call to Order

The meeting was called to order at 6:13 pm by Board Chair Eddie Wang.

Consent Agenda (Resolutions 7178 through 7184)

Time: 6:14 pm

Appreciation was shared for staff who oversee out of state field trips approvals.

Actions Taken

- Director DePass moved and Director Sullivan seconded the motion to adopt Consent Agenda, including Resolutions 7178 through 7184. The motion was put to a voice vote and passed (7 yes – 0 no – 0 abstain)

  Chase-Miller: Yes; DePass: Yes; Engelsman: Yes; La Forte: Yes; Splitt: Yes; Sullivan: Yes; Wang: Yes; Student Representative Ritorto: Yes (unofficial)

Fund for PPS Annual Report

Time: 6:17 pm

Staff: Deborah Kafoury – Chief of Staff; Robyn Faraone – Director of Strategic Partnerships, Fund for PPS Staff Liaison

Fund for PPS: Jackie Wirz – Fund for PPS Board Chair

Ms. Wirz provided a report on the Fund for PPS. The presentation highlighted the fund's growth, priorities, and plans, adding that they are working to shift their work after a 2024 Board Policy change. It was noted that the fund invests in student programming and hardship assistance, and that Champion PPS was created for donations specifically designated for staffing. Looking ahead, the Fund for PPS team will focus on building capacity by hiring an Executive Director, recruiting board and parent advisors, and engaging the broader community to support continued growth.

Finance Focus: Contracts and Procurement

Time: 7:24 pm

Staff: Emily Courtnage – Director, Purchase and Contracting; Michelle Morrison – Chief Financial Officer; Paul Williams – Senior Solicitations Manager

Staff provided an overview of purchasing and contracting at Portland Public Schools, including governing rules, procurement thresholds, competitive bidding, contract review and approval, and the Board's role in the process. Board members asked questions and provided comments, with topics including national best practices for board approval of contracts, the Request for Proposal (RFP) process and thresholds, use of cooperative purchasing, evaluation of contract effectiveness and affordability, equity in contracting considerations, and contract renewals. There was a request to consider changing Board Policy to increase contracting thresholds to $250,000 to align with national best practices.

Board Work Plan

Time: 8:01 pm

Staff: Dr. Renard Adams – Chief Accountability and Equity Officer; Deborah Kafoury – Chief of Staff; Rosanne Powell – Senior Manager, Board of Education

Director Wang provided an overview of the draft Board Workplan. Board members discussed adjustments to the work plan, including clarifying timelines, highlighting board actions, refining categories, and considering additional topics such as absenteeism, academic achievement, enrollment boundaries, and legislative priorities. Staff highlighted the regular intervals for academic and attendance reporting.

Board Stipend Discussion

Time: 9:14 pm

Staff: Sharon Toncray – Chief Legal Officer

Chair Wang introduced the concept of board member stipends, noting that while members are not currently paid, state law allows for it. Staff outlined three options for implementation, clarifying that no option would include the student representative and that participation would be optional. Board members discussed the financial burdens of serving and role of stipends in supporting board diversity, and acknowledged the potential for political or media backlash. There was general interest in approving stipends using Option 2. The item will be brought forward for consideration on October 14, 2025.

Future Board Topics

Time: 9:40 pm

Chair Wang reviewed possible future agenda items recommended by Board Members. There was a reminder to submit audit topics to the internal auditor.

Adjournment

The Board meeting was adjourned at 9:43 pm by Board Chair Eddie Wang.

Submitted by:

Kara Bradshaw
Executive Assistant/Board Clerk
Portland Public Schools

Resolutions As Adopted

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RESOLUTION No. 7178

Expenditure Contracts that Exceed $150,000 for Delegation of Authority

RECITAL

Portland Public Schools ("District") Public Contracting Rules PPS-45-0200 ("Authority to Approve District Contracts; Delegation of Authority to Superintendent") requires the Board of Education ("Board") enter into contracts and approve payment for products, materials, supplies, capital outlay, equipment, and services whenever the total amount exceeds $150,000 per contract, excepting settlement or real property agreements. Contracts meeting this criterion are listed below.

RESOLUTION

The Superintendent recommends that the Board approve these contracts. The Board accepts this recommendation and by this resolution authorizes the Deputy Clerk to enter into the following agreements.

NEW CONTRACTS

Contractor	Contract Term	Contract Type	Description of Services	Contract Amount	Responsible Admin, Funding Source	Certified Business
Computer Technology Link Corp.	10/1/25	Purchase Order PO 260697	Warranty extension on District Chromebooks. Sole Source PPS-47-0275	$422,960	T. Odgers Fund 101 Dept. 5582	No
Mt. Scott Park Center for Learning, Inc.	10/1/25 through 8/31/26	Personal Services PS 97021	Distribution of additional funds available for use by contracted alternative education providers. Request for Proposals 2020-2894	$291,498	I. Cardona Funding Source Varies	N/A - nonprofit
Rosemary Anderson High School	10/1/25 through 8/31/26	Personal Services PS 97022	Distribution of additional funds available for use by contracted alternative education providers. Request for Proposals 2020-2894	$756,201	I. Cardona Funding Source Varies	N/A – nonprofit
Raptor Technologies, LLC	10/1/25 through 6/30/28	Digital Resource DR 97041	Three year license for visitor and volunteer data management software. Special Class Procurement – Software Upgrades and/or Maintenance PPS-47-0288(11)	$171,451	J. Franco Fund 101 Dept. 5530	No

*A Certified Business is a for-profit business certified as a Minority-Owned Businesses (MBE), Women-Owned Businesses (WBE), Emerging Small Businesses (ESB), and/or Service-Disabled Veteran Businesses (SDV) by the State of Oregon Certification Office for Business Inclusion and Diversity.

NEW COOPERATIVE PURCHASING AGREEMENTS

Contractor	Contract Term, Renewal Options	Administering Contracting Agency	Description of Goods or Services	Estimated Spend During Contract Term	Responsible Administrator, Funding Source
Corporate Travel Management	10/1/25 through 3/14/29	State of Oregon / NASPO ValuePoint COA 96984	Provide travel management services including airfare reservations and booking, lodging services, car rental reservations, and related services on an as-needed basis.	$1,000,000	M. Morrison Funding Source Varies

NEW INTERGOVERNMENTAL AGREEMENTS ("IGAs")

Contractor	Contract Term	Contract Type	Description of Services	Contract Amount	Responsible Administrator, Funding Source

Centennial School District	7/1/25 through 6/30/26	Intergovernmental Agreement IGA 96960	Columbia Regional Inclusive Services will partner to deliver regional services to eligible individuals with Autism Spectrum Disorder.	$151,000	J. Buno Fund 205 Dept. 5433 Grant G2428
Oregon City School District	7/1/25 through 6/30/26	Intergovernmental Agreement IGA 96995	Columbia Regional Inclusive Services will partner to deliver regional services to eligible individuals with Autism Spectrum Disorder.	$198,000	J. Buno Fund 205 Dept. 5433 Grant G2428
Lake Oswego School District	7/1/25 through 6/30/26	Intergovernmental Agreement IGA 96997	Columbia Regional Inclusive Services will partner to deliver regional services to eligible individuals with Autism Spectrum Disorder.	$203,000	J. Buno Fund 205 Dept. 5433 Grant G2428
Portland Community College	10/1/25 through 8/31/26	Intergovernmental Agreement IGA 97034	Distribution of additional funds available for use by contracted alternative education providers. Request for Proposals 2020-2894	$511,896	I. Cardona Funding Source Varies
Multnomah Education Service District (MESD)	10/1/25 through 8/31/26	Intergovernmental Agreement IGA 97038	Distribution of additional funds available for use by contracted alternative education providers.	$183,622	I. Cardona Funding Source Varies

AMENDMENTS TO EXISTING CONTRACTS

Contractor	Amendment Term	Contract Type	Description of Services	Amendment Amount; New Contract Amount	Responsible Administrator, Funding Source	Certified Business
ESS West, LLC	10/1/25 through 8/15/26	Personal Services PS 96989 Amendment 1	Provide substitute support staff services in Special Education. This amendment extends scope for entire 25-26 school year. Request for Proposals 2025-012	$1,250,000 $1,390,000	S. Toncray Fund 101 Dept. 6299	No
Pac Green Landscape, LLC	10/1/25 through 10/17/26 Option to renew for up to three additional one-year terms through 10/17/29	Services S 95921 Amendment 2	Provide ongoing maintenance of existing vegetated stormwater facilities. This amendment extends the contract for one additional year and adds funds. Invitation to Bid 2024-035	$165,654 $307,287 Total through all renewals: $638,595	T. Odgers Fund 101 Dept. 5592	No
Carahsoft Technology Corp.	10/1/25 through 9/25/26	Cooperative Contract COA 90176 Amendment 2	Adds purchase of Abnormal AI email security software licenses.	$500,000 $1,500,000	T. Odgers Funding Source Varies	No
Advanced Security, Inc.	10/1/25 through 12/31/25	Services S 95678 Amendment 1	Uniformed, unarmed on-site security officers. This amendment adds officers to eight additional PPS sites for up to 30 days. Quotes	$100,000 $250,000	J. Franco Fund 101, 191 Dept. 5560, 5592	No

RESOLUTION No. 7179

Revenue Contracts that Exceed $150,000 for Delegation of Authority

RECITAL

Portland Public Schools ("District") Public Contracting Rules PPS-45-0200 ("Authority to Approve District Contracts; Delegation of Authority to Superintendent") requires the Board of Education ("Board") enter into contracts, except as otherwise expressly authorized. Contracts exceeding $150,000 per contractor are listed below.

RESOLUTION

The Superintendent recommends that the Board approve these contracts. The Board accepts this recommendation and by this resolution authorizes the Deputy Clerk to enter into the following agreements.

NEW REVENUE CONTRACTS

No new Revenue Contracts

NEW INTERGOVERNMENTAL AGREEMENTS ("IGAs")

Contractor	Contract Term	Contract Type	Description of Services	Contract Amount	Responsible Admin, Funding Source
Gresham-Barlow School District	8/20/25 through 6/30/26	Intergovernmental Agreement / Revenue IGA/R 96973	Columbia Regional Inclusive Services will provide classroom and interpreter services for Deaf/Hard of Hearing regionally eligible children.	$208,230	J. Buno
State of Oregon	7/1/25 through 9/30/25	Intergovernmental Agreement / Revenue IGA/R 97036	Oregon Comprehensive Literacy State Development (CLSD) grant	$1,100,000	K. Howard

AMENDMENTS TO EXISTING CONTRACTS

No New Amendments to Existing Revenue Contracts

RESOLUTION No. 7180

Adoption of the Minutes

The Following Minutes are offered for Adoption:

- September 9, 2025 – Regular Meeting
- September 18, 2025 – Special Meeting

RESOLUTION No. 7181

Authorization for Off-Campus Activities

RECITAL

Portland Public Schools ("District") Policy 6.50.010-P ("Off-Campus Activities") requires the Board of Education ("Board") consent to student out-of-state travel.

RESOLUTION

The Board has reviewed the request for out-of-state travel. All required documents have been submitted to the Risk Management Department. The Superintendent recommends that the Board consent to the student out-of-state travel for the below request:

AUTHORIZATION FOR OFF-CAMPUS ACTIVITIES

Date(s)	School, Course, & Number of Students	Purpose of Travel	Travel Destination	Estimated Cost	Equitable Field Trip Fund; %
10/3-10/4/25	Lincoln HS Cross Country, 14	509 Invitational	Spokane, WA	$360	N/A

RESOLUTION No. 7182

Resolution to Appoint Three Members to the 2025-2026
Climate Crisis Response Committee (CCRC)

RECITALS

A. On March 1, 2022, the Portland Public Schools Board of Education adopted the Climate Crisis Response, Climate Justice and Sustainable Practices Policy–3.30.080-P .

B. The Climate Crisis Response, Climate Justice and Sustainable Practices Policy requires the establishment of a committee to monitor effective implementation, transparency, and tracking of progress.

C. The Charter for the Climate Crisis Response Committee indicates that members will initially be appointed to staggered terms of one and two years with all subsequent terms being two years. Each member may serve up to four years total on the Committee.

D. The Charter for the Climate Crisis Response Committee indicates that two positions of the committee will be specifically for student members with terms of one year.

E. Three committee members' terms ended and one committee member stepped down from serving, leaving four positions available for the adult CCRC member appointment, in addition to the annual recruitment of two student members.

RESOLUTION

1. The Board of Education appoints Alma Valls (student) and Leah Almeida (student) to the Climate Crisis Response Committee as student representatives. The term of these appointments is one year.

2. The Board of Education appoints Leah Werner, Shannon Adams, America Tirado, and Murtaza Balta to the Climate Crisis Response Committee as adult representatives. The term of this appointment is two years.

RESOLUTION No. 7183

Approving Board Member Conference Attendance as Representatives of the Board

RECITALS

Board Policy 1.40.070 requires Board approval for individual Board members to attend state or national meetings as representatives of the Board.

RESOLUTION

The Board affirms Vice Chair Michele DePass, attend the California Association of Black School Educators Conference in Carlsbad, CA, from October 16-18, 2025.

Resolution No. 7184

Authorizing Indemnification of PPS Employees Acting in Scope and Course of Employment

Recitals

A. ORS 30.285 and Portland Public Schools Policy 5.50.020-P provide that the District will defend and indemnify its employees against any tort claim arising out of an alleged act or omission that occurred in the performance of their job duties.

B. Except for limited circumstances, that obligation extends to only tort claims.

C. The Board recognizes the need to encourage employees to effectively and efficiently perform their duties and to protect employees in the performance of their duties, including claims that may arise from signing grants, contracts, or other documents approved by the Board.

D. PPS employees regularly make certifications to the federal government on behalf of the District in the performance of their job duties that may subject them to investigation or claims brought by the federal government or individuals acting on behalf of the federal government.

Resolution

1. The PPS Board of Education Policy Committee will engage in a review of Policy 5.50.020-P to assess reasonable defense and indemnification protections may be afforded PPS employees beyond tort claims.

2. Until that review is complete, the District agrees to provide legal counsel to employees who are a defendant or threatened with being made a defendant to any threatened, pending or contemplated civil, administrative or investigative action, suit or proceeding based on an alleged violation of federal law ("Proceeding") by reason of the fact that the person was an employee of the District and performed duties within the scope and course of their employment. The District will also indemnify such employees against all expenses, fines, and damages incurred in such Proceeding provided that the District does not determine, in the District's discretion, that an employee did not act in good faith within the scope of their authority, role, and duties or that the employee did not reasonably believe their actions were lawful, reasonable, and in the best interest of the District.

3. Any employee claiming indemnification must immediately notify the District's Chief Legal Officer of any Proceeding. The Chief Legal Officer, in turn, will notify the Board of any claim for defense and indemnification under this Resolution.